

Liberman, G. 2010. *Stace. Silves, Édition et commentaire critiques par G.L.* Paris, Calepinus. 546 pp. Pr. €59. ISBN 9782951775947.

In the last thirty years, eight book-size works (including the book under review) have been published with the aim of consolidating our understanding of the text of Statius' *Silvae*: van Dam on book 2 (Leiden 1984); Coleman on book 4 (Oxford 1988); the Oxford edition of E. Courtney (1990, 1992²); Laguna Mariscal on book 3 (Madrid/Sevilla 1992); the edition of Shackleton Bailey in the Loeb Classical Library (2003); and Gibson on book 5 (Oxford 2006). The commentary on book 2 by C. Newlands (Cambridge 2011) did not appear in time for L. (= Liberman) to take into account. In my review of Courtney, I stated that it deserved to endure for decades as the standard edition of the *Silvae* (*Gnomon* 66 [1994], 17). L. has committed himself to the Herculean task of examining and discussing the very numerous passages in the *Silvae* in which the text has been corruptly transmitted. He has made a good job of a difficult task. The question is whether L.'s edition has managed to replace that of Courtney as the standard text of the *Silvae*.

The book is divided into a preface "Au lecteur" (pp. 7-29), a note on the titles and the order of the poems (31-5), a list of references cited (37-56), the edition of the Latin text together with dense and detailed commentary at the foot of the page, in French (57-481), indexes of proper names (483-511), of general names (512-39), of passages discussed from other works (540-1), and *Addenda et Corrigenda* (542-4).

The book's most serious problem is its ambiguity of purpose. In the preface, L. attempts to clarify his edition's aims, which are not to provide the most plausible text that Statius may have written (which, in my opinion, would be what could be expected from a book that has been called an "Édition critique" on the cover), but "donner au lecteur les moyens d'établir son propre texte" (p. 7). This declaration of intent will be relevant to the nature of the printed text and commentary, as we shall see. In regard to the commentary, L. states that it will not be merely of a textual character, but will also be exegetic and cultural (p. 8); he specifies that this "exégèse correcte" can spare the text from unnecessary corrections, and uses as an example, somewhat boastfully, a collection of five passages saved from emendation thanks to his "correct exegesis" (1.4.45; 3.1.151; 4.6.19; 4.8.41; 3.3.89-95). In fact, in two (4.6.19; 3.3.89-95) of the five passages, the text is not (and has never been) in question. In the commentary, L. presents us with many notes certainly irrelevant to the establishment of the text, and whose main purpose seems to be to display erudition: for instance, 1.2.37 on a fragment by Sappho; 1.2.51-146 on Apollonius Rhodius; 1.2.99 on myrtle and laurel; 1.3.31-2 on Flavius Josephus; 1.4.9 on the cult of military standards; 2.1.161 on the occurrences of *Palaestina* and *Palaestinus* in Latin; at 2.2.31 a lengthy discussion on the meaning of *urbis opus* does not involve the

text; at 1.2.166 L. lists the intertextual links of *exerce formam*, as expression of the *carpe diem*-topos (for which see my paper “Invitación al matrimonio: en torno a un pasaje estaciano (*silu.* I 2, 161-200)”, *Emerita* 62 [1994], 263-88, not cited by L.).

Next, in the preface itself, L. outlines a summary of the textual history of the *Silvae* (pp. 9-29). As is well known, the text of the *Silvae* depends on a single and late manuscript testimony, M (*Matritensis* 3678), which was copied in 1417. On M depend all of the other manuscripts from the 15th century, known by critics as *Itali* and whose readings are normally cited in critical apparatuses (and L. is no exception) with the collective *siglum* ζ. The first printed editions were based on the *Itali*, for only since the editions of Vollmer (1898) and Klotz (1900) have readings of M been incorporated. The M manuscript is plagued with errors, but, according to L. (p. 12), these errors are in the majority mechanical, banal, and easy to correct. There is a second level of errors, deeper and more difficult to correct, that goes back to the source. On this point, L. reasonably argues that it is not correct to attribute these errors to a bold diction proper to Statius or the Flavian era (p. 16). L. next presents the principal contributions to the discussion that have been published in the past, and that he takes as basic: he especially renders homage to Markland's edition with commentary (1728, 1827²), the *Diatribes* of F. Gronovius (1637), and the unfinished commentary (on only the first three *Silvae* of book I) of F. Hand (1817). He rescues the value of Stephens' edition (1651), in spite of its being a school book (p. 27). For another thing, it is surprising that L. regrets the lack of a *variorum* edition with commentary for the *Silvae*, “semblable à celle que Burman l'Ancien a donnée de Valerius Flaccus (1724)” (p. 17), when he includes in his Bibliography the quite useful *variorum* editions by Veenhusen (Leiden 1671), Valpy (London 1824) and Amar-Lemaire (Paris 1825).

L. disputes the authenticity of the *tituli* that head individual *silvae* (pp. 31-3), essentially following the long-winded and unconvincing arguments of Coleman (1988, pp. xxviii-xxxii). I believe that no single good reason exists that would negate Statius' authorship of these titles. Coleman and L. are uneasy about the fact that some generic terms (*propempticon*, *eucharisticon*, *ode*) appear in Latin for the first time in the titles, but L. himself must concede (p. 32) that another generic term, *genethliacon*, not attested elsewhere until much later, occurs both in the *titulus* of 2.7 and in the preface to book 2. This supports the authenticity of the titles, unless one would also challenge Statius' authorship of the prefaces. In any case, B.-J. Schröder (*Titel und Text*, Berlin/New York 1999, 180-90) and R.R. Nauta (*Poetry for Patrons*, Leiden 2002, 269-72) have settled the question, unfortunately without convincing L. Recently, Newlands has adopted an intermediate and cautious position about this *vexata quaestio* (p. 7).

In the discussion of the transmitted text, L. displays a sharp critical sense (at times we might say hypercritical). He submits the text to scrutiny with good sense and attention to detail, and this frequently results in the restoration of a plausible

text, correcting M's readings by means of the conjectures of great scholars like Markland, Gronovius, Heinsius, Håkanson or Courtney. L. has not collated M, nor the *Itali* nor the early printed editions; rather he depends for their recension on modern editions, notably Klotz, Marastoni and Courtney (at 1.2.194 his note reads: "*taciteque* Otto et peut-être M (selon Courtney)", while M has *tacitoque*). 1.2.98 *sed* (Politian) for *sic* (M) smoothes the syntax. 1.2.197 the dative of agent *uati* (Markland) for *uatis* (M) is undoubtedly right. 1.2.201 *placitissime* (Hopf, Schrader) restores good sense over the somewhat ridiculous *placidissime* (M). 1.3.80 *huc* is a good conjecture by L. himself for M's *et*. 1.4.120 *aucupor* (Heinsius) is required in the context instead of the semantically anomalous *auguror* (M). At 2.2.137 it is to L.'s credit that he prints *rectique errore* (Courtney) for the silly *plectrique errore* (M). At 3.1.82 the phrase *dicta sacris* (Markland: *sacri* M), interpreted by L. as "consecrated to cult", provides good sense. 3.1.97 *erum* (Håkanson) for *erant* (M) gives the required sense to the phrase and is supported by several parallels in the *Silvae*. At 3.1.151 I changed *ridetque* (M) to *visitque*, because I gave credit to the *OLD*, according to which *rideo* plus accusative is not Latin for "to laugh/smile at" (as a sign of sympathy or goodwill); I now stand corrected and accept *ridetque*, but then it follows that: 1) the entry for *rideo* in the *OLD* should be corrected; 2) what Vergil wrote in *Ecl.* 4.62 is *qui non risere parentes* ("who did not smile at their parents"), *pace* L. in his note (p. 263), which Juan Luis de la Cerda had already defended in his commentary of Vergil (*P. Virgilii Maronis Bucolica et Georgica*, Lugduni 1619, p. 80; see F. Moya del Baño, "La sonrisa del puer en Virgilio (E. 4, 62): apostillas a la interpretación de J.L. de la Cerda", *Helmantica* 44 [1993], 235-50). 3.2.75 <g>*audebant* is the brilliant conjecture by Markland for *audebant* (M). 3.3.15 *umbram / matris* (Markland), paralleled in *Alcestis Barcinonensis* 99, is a necessary correction for *umquam / matris* (M), though no one could guess from L.'s note that I put forward the *Alcestis* parallel. I also stand corrected at 3.3.179-80, where the text resulting from a double emendation is flawless: *Haud aliter gemit per Sunia* (Polster: *periu-ria* M) *Theseus / litora quem* (Shackleton Bailey: *qui* M) *falsis deceperat Aegea uelis*. At 3.3.64 the infinitive *gradi* (Meursius) improves *gradu* (M). At 3.4.66 *fuscaret gaudia formae, gaudia* is the brilliant correction by Gronovius for *gratia* (M); *gratia* would imply that *fuscare* should be taken in the intransitive sense "to become dark", the only instance in Latin, according to the *OLD* and the *TLL*.

L.'s usual procedure is to print the transmitted reading (M) in the text with *obeli*, while he defends a conjecture in the commentary. As a consequence, L.'s text contains some 210 *obeli* (the highest number that I have documented in all the editions of the *Silvae*, against, for instance, 8 *obeli* in the Teubner edition by Marastoni [1961], 34 in Courtney, or 6 in Shackleton Bailey). In other instances, L. prints a transmitted reading in the text, without *obeli*, but in the note advocates an emendation. This procedure is irritating when the readings defended in the notes deserve to be printed in the text. 1.1.28 *et minor in leges iret gener et Cato* †*castris*†

seems the result of the corruption of *et minor in leges gener et Cato castris iret* (suggested independently by Scriverius and Housman, accepted by Courtney). At 1.1.63-5 for *strepit ardua pulsu / machina; continuus septem per culmina †montis† / it fragor* (M) L. defends in the note the highly plausible *strepit ardua pulsu / machina continuo: septem per culmina longus / it fragor* (Markland). 1.2.9 †futura† (M) should be corrected to *furata* (Slater, Shackleton Bailey); L. writes: “[I]a faute futura pour furata est limpide”. 1.2.62 †ore† was corrected to *torre* (referring to Cupid’s torch) by Heinsius; L., while seemingly accepting *torre* in the note, leaves *ore* obelized in the text. At 1.2.119 for the impossible †potuisset† (M) L. defends *licuisset* (conjectured by Eden) in the note. At 1.2.186 for the odd *rarescunt* (M) L. prefers *tabescunt* (Wakefield) in the note, without receiving it into the text. 1.3.56 *superatque* (M) produces an awkward syntactic construction, repaired by *superare* (Markland). At 1.3.103 for †turbes†(M) “[I]a meilleure conjecture est uibres de Scriverius”. At 1.6.64 for †pumilos† (M) *solito* (Shackleton Bailey, anticipated by Stephens) is rightly defended by L. but relegated to the note. At 2.1.28 for the unmetrical †Et diu† L. defends the conjecture *crudi* (Shackleton Bailey) in the note: “me semble la meilleure des conjectures”. At 2.1.223 for †meruitue†, *renuitue* (Heinsius, Markland, Housman) is an almost certain correction which L. accepts, but does not admit into the text. At 2.2.15 for the doubtful *unum* (M) L. thinks that “[u]dum est en revanche parfaitement pertinent”. 2.2.35 the absurd *lyceo* (M) finds a good correction in *Lechaeo* (vulgate reading); the objection raised by van Dam (there was not a portico from the *Lechaeum* [harbor of Corynthus] to Corynthus) was contested by R. Mayer in his review of van Dam: see *CR* 36 (1986), 51. At 3.1.175, speaking *pro domo mea*, I find it particularly disappointing that L. defends at length (10 lines of note) my *iuuenem* and then leaves †iuuenes† in the text. 4.3.51 *scolopas* (a brilliant conjecture by Nisbet, printed by Coleman) should be placed into the text for †scopulos† (M).

In a few passages, L. seems to have misunderstood the text or his preferences are unacceptable to me. At 1.1.54-55 *hic domini numquam mutabit habenas / perpetuus frenis atque uni seruiet astro*, L., not understanding the construction, takes *frenis* as complement of *perpetuus* and postulates a comma after *frenis*; in fact, both *frenis* and *uni astro* depend on *seruiet* and the comma should go after *habenas*. At 1.3.42 *nox silet et pigros †imitantia† murmura somnos* (*nigros* M) I still hold that *pigros* has a strong derogatory overtone in Latin, as Markland warned, and I take for certain the correction *et teneros inuitant murmura somnos* (*teneros* Markland, Willis: *inuitant* Laetus, Gronovius); the passages and the note by van Dam referred to by L. confirm in fact the derogatory sense of *piger*; besides, L. reckons *inuitant* a “solution très plausible”. 1.6.13 there is no reason to obelize †cadit†. 3.1.157 *Lybicas . . . palaestras* (M), which is supposed to evoke the fight of Heracles with the Libyan giant Antaeus, is out of place to qualify bloodless fights (cf. 3.1.43-4 *festa / gymnas, et insontes iuuenum sine caestibus irae*) and should be emended to

liquidas . . . palaestras (Markland); see the parallels cited in my commentary, p. 182. At 3.1.164 *nunc ipsum in limine cerno* (*ipsum* Calderini: *ipse* M), *ipse* should stay (referring to the grammatical subject of *cerno*), since the combination *ipse . . . cerno* emphasizes the miraculous privilege of witnessing a divine epiphany (cf. Verg. *Ecl.* 10.26 *Pan deus Arcadiae uenit, quem uidimus ipsi*, A. 4.358 *ipse deum manifesto in lumine uidi*). At 3.5.10 *thalamos†que armata†negasses*, L. prefers the weak *thalamos firmata negasses* (Delz), while my conjecture *thalamo intemerata negasses* is not even deemed worthy of mention; the stock phrase *thalamo intemerata* restores sense and construction to the line (see 5.1.62 and *Theb.* 4.579). At 3.5.57-9 *Non sic Trachinia nidos / Alcyone †neruos† non sic Philomela penates / circumit*, the customary correction is *uernos*, but the adjective *uernos* with *penates* (l. 58) contributes a trivial notion and spoils the anaphora *Non sic . . . non sic*; it is preferable to print *hibernos*, agreeing with *nidos* (l. 57): *hibernos . . . nidos* are the “halcyon nests”; this correction preserves the anaphora and underlines the relevant point that the halcyon nests in winter (see Stat. *Theb.* 9.362 *algentes . . . nidos*, Ov. *Met.* 9.745-6; C. Beck noticed the problem and suggested *madidos* or *humidos* in *P. Papinii Statii ad Calpurnium Pisonem poemation*, Onoldi 1825, 20), but L. misses the point and prefers *uernos* for the single reason that “*uernos penates* est plus poétique”. 3.5.75 *Dicarchei* is a typo for *Dicaearchi* (see 3.1.92 and the *Index nominum*, p. 490, s. v. *Dicaearchus*). At 3.5.105-6 *Mille tibi nostrae referam telluris honores? / Sed satis hoc . . .*, L. missed the opportunity to restore the correct punctuation, suppressing the question mark (which ruins the syntactic movement). At 5.3.263 for *gauisauque nouit* (M), L. rightly accepts *gauisa notauit* but by a slip of the pen he prints *gauisauque no<ta>uit* (unmetrical).

In conclusion, L. has dedicated an enormous effort to the discussion of the text of the *Silvae*, and for this he has thoroughly examined the secondary scholarly documentation. Unfortunately, he did not fix for himself as the ultimate objective the establishment of a text, but takes the text as a simple basis or point of departure for further discussion. As a result, he has produced an excellent commentary, which constitutes an impressive contribution to the textual discussion of the *Silvae*. On the other hand, Statian scholars and philologists should continue to access Courtney's edition for a standard text of the *Silvae*, at least until a new edition is published in the Teubner series.¹

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¹ I am grateful to Dennis Mangan for the English translation of this review. This review forms part of the Research Project FFI 2009-13368, financed by the Ministerio de Ciencia y Tecnología of Spain.